

SEWANG MARKET INSIGHT · JUNE CLOSING

SEWANG

세 왕 상 사

2026 First-Half Closing June Market Insight Report

Where did the market move this month — a closing review of the four summer categories, plus this issue's special: "Japan's Non-Alcoholic Specialty Venues & A Guide to Korea's Non-Alcoholic Products"

Published **2026.06.29** · For external trade-partner distribution · Data: Sometrend · Korea Customs Service · Samil PwC · SEWANG internal statistics

+102%

Non-alcoholic beer
tripled in 3 months

+21%

Draft beer
entering summer season

+4%

Highball
stable after peak

-19%

Sake
summer off-season

KRW 70.4B

Non-alc beer market
2025 → KRW 94.6B (2027)

37.5%

Hite Zero share
No.1 in non-alc beer

June in one line — As the summer peak season arrives, **draft beer (+21%)** and **non-alcoholic (+102%)** are riding the wave, highball holds on through variations, and sake repositions for a cool summer. The fastest-growing category among them is **non-alcoholic** — in Japan, dedicated "non-alcoholic specialty venues" have already appeared. This issue's special covers Japanese cases and the non-alcoholic products selling well in Korea, broken down by category.

PART 01 · JUNE CATEGORY CLOSING

The Four Summer Categories — June's Report Card

Sometrend Instagram monthly mention volume, measured — change for Mar/Apr/May vs. the prior quarter. Includes a June action guide for each category.

Draft Beer

+21%

▲ HOT · Summer default



May peak **6,863** (highest in 7 months). Peaks every June-July — the most predictable summer demand. Associated terms: chicken, cool/refreshing, good-eats, atmosphere.

Action · Expand kegs (Cass, Terra, Hite) +20-30% by mid-June · 1 main seasonal SKU + 1 differentiator (Sapporo Draft, Stella).

Non-Alcoholic Beer

+102%

▲ BOOM · A quiet surge



Doubled in just 3 months. Not a fad but a "habit" taking root. Newly captures designated drivers, healthy-pleasure seekers, expectant mothers, and daytime drinkers.

Action · Keep 1-2 bottle SKUs always in stock (Cass Zero, Heineken 0.0) · Add +1 when Hite ZERO launches · Separate menu card for drivers and health-conscious guests.

Highball

+4%

► STEADY · Variations win



Stable sideways movement after the December peak of **8,465**. The peak has passed, but it remains the No.1 dining-out order — reinforce per-customer spend by **turning whisky-based highballs into signatures**.

Action · Kakubin, Jim Beam, Ballantine's + tonic + dedicated-glass kit · Classic + flavored (yuzu, grapefruit) + 1 house signature.

Sake

-19%

◆ REPOS. · Summer off-season



December peak **5,600** → May 3,620 (-35%). Clear seasonality. The warm-sake off-season, but **switching to chilled sake can defend summer volumes**.

Action · Slim summer SKUs + a dedicated chilled (hiyazake) line + a sake-highball kit (junmai + soda) · Emphasize sushi/Japanese-cuisine pairings.

The Venues SNS Lined Up — Why They Took Off

We combed Instagram, YouTube, and Naver blogs to gather the venues in Seoul and Gyeonggi that actually drew lines in the first half of 2026. They may look scattered, but they group into four flows — and within them, a path emerges.

▲ Rising

Yajang (outdoor-table) and old-school nostalgia · Draft beer · Non-alcoholic · Natural wine and corkage · Solo/by-the-glass drinking · Old-school spots featured on Culinary Class Wars or by YouTubers

▼ Cooling

Highball (past its peak, sideways) · **Sake** (summer off-season) · Concept-less "anything-goes" bottle shops · Venues overly reliant on heavy interior design

1 The Summer of Yajang (Outdoor Tables)

▲ Draft turnover ↑

The keyword most ridden across SNS this summer was "**yajang**" (**outdoor street-side tables**). Euljiro's Nogari Alley made a comeback as the "mecca of yajang," spreading to Seosulla-gil, Jongno pocha streets, and Haebangchon's Sinheung Market, and the concept was even replicated into Gyeonggi areas like Jeongja-dong. Even in the heat, a venue with **outdoor tables + old-school retro mood + value-for-money snacks** draws a line. Add the World Cup (hosted across North & Central America) viewing-party boost, and draft beer turnover is hitting its peak.

Moa Sikpum (모아식품)

Euljiro · Mareunnae-ro 61-6 · Old-school samgyeopsal yajang

Munchen Hof (뮌헨호프)

Euljiro Nogari Alley · Euljiro 14-gil 30 · Draft beer

Cheonggyecheon Hue (청계천 휴)

Jongno · Cheonggyecheon-ro 71 · Domestic draft beer garden & yajang

Dalmaji Gwangjang Barbecue, Jeongja branch (달맞이광장바베큐 정자점)

Seongnam Bundang/Jeongja · BBQ meat house · Outdoor & draft beer-driven

SEWANG link

The decisive factor for yajang and pocha is **keg turnover and refrigeration management**. SEWANG supplies the seasonal keg volumes of Cass, Terra, and Hite, plus the non-alcoholic bottle line.

2

Corkage & Wine Bars — Not "to drink," but "to experience"

▲ Natural wine ↑

Centered on Seongsu and Hannam, **wine bars rose as "experience spaces."** The core keywords are **corkage (free/allowed)**, cheese and charcuterie platters, and "one SNS-worthy shot." More venues run a "day-to-night switch" — café by day, natural wine by night — pulling in group demand with free corkage.

Your Naked Cheese (유어네이키드치즈)

Seongsu · Wangsimni-ro 10-gil 6 · Free corkage, cheese platters

Bangul-gwa Kkomak (방울과꼬막)

Hannam-dong · Daesagwan-ro 30-gil 11-5 · Celebrity hotspot

SEWANG link

Wine bars only sustain turnover when they cover **glass/house wine + sparkling + non-alcoholic 0.0** in one go. SEWANG curates and supplies bottle-shop and wine-bar lineups.

3

A One-Sentence Concept — Pairing, Flat Pricing, Solo Drinking

▲ Scalability ↑

Venues that can be explained in one line expanded. The clearer the concept — **chicken + draft beer (chimaek), oysters + wine, by-the-glass solo drinking, single flat price across the whole menu** — the harder it is to copy and the more loyal regulars it builds. Flat pricing that removes the "what should I order" dilemma, and solo bars where "it's not awkward to come alone," are the standouts.

Goobne Beer Pub, Sookmyung branch

Sookmyung univ. district · Chicken + draft beer combo

Yahwa Solo Bar

Solo / by-the-glass · Instagram posts +134%

oyoyoy Oyster Bar

Seongsu → Euljiro/Yeonnam · Oysters + wine

Torikizoku Hongdae

All menu items KRW 4,900 flat · 3 branches in a year

SEWANG link

The more concept-driven the venue, the more a **signature kit** is the weapon. SEWANG designs and supplies kits bundling highball base spirits, dedicated glassware, by-the-glass sake, and non-alcoholic options.

4

Old-School Spots Ignited by Media

▲ Waitlists exploding

Once a **Culinary Class Wars chef or a famous YouTuber** drops by, waiting lines explode at long-established old-school spots. It's a structure where media exposure ignites an already-proven venue — it's not new interior design but "story" that brings in guests. (e.g., the Euljiro old-school cluster, including **Jumadeung 2nd branch** by the Mr. Saigon chef from Culinary Class Wars, and **Jamae Bunsik**, visited by Tzuyang.)

SEWANG link

The weapon of old-school spots and popular eateries is ultimately **"cold, well-managed drinks."** When media drives a rush of guests, stable supply with no stockouts is what backs them up.

※ Venue information is based on Instagram/Naver blog mention volume and cross-verification across two or more sources (Naver and Kakao Map) for the first half of 2026. These venues are SNS-buzz examples, introduced for market-trend reference regardless of any SEWANG trade relationship. Sales figures are not disclosed.

SPECIAL · THIS ISSUE'S FEATURE

Non-Alcoholic Enters the "Specialty Venue" Era

How Japan Is Selling It

Drawing on Japanese-language local media, Tabelog, and Instagram, we cover the rising non-alcoholic specialty venues, plus the non-alcoholic products selling well in Korea, broken down by category.

FEATURE 01 · WHY NON-ALCOHOLIC NOW

An Era Where "Not Drinking Is Cool" — The Fastest-Growing Lane

As sober-curious, healthy-pleasure, and designated-driver cultures overlap, non-alcoholic is almost the only category growing in a stagnant alcohol market.

+102%

SNS mentions, 3 months
(Instagram, measured)

KRW

70.4B

Non-alc beer market
2025 → KRW 94.6B
(2027)

37.5%

Hite Zero share
No.1 in non-alc beer

56%

Ages 20s–30s
"I drink it even when not
driving"

Korea's non-alcoholic / low-alcohol beer market had been growing double digits every year, and this year the growth rate **jumped into the 80% range** (Euromonitor). E-Mart's non-alcoholic sales were +21% YoY, and Q1 non-alcoholic sales were +27.7%. The key is that it's not "can't drink," but more guests **choosing not to drink** — and the vessel for that demand is precisely **mocktails and non-alcoholic specialty venues**, where Japan is a step ahead.

FEATURE 02 · NON-ALCOHOLIC SPECIALTY VENUES RISING IN JAPAN

In Japan, "Bars That Sell Only Non-Alcoholic" Are Rising — 3 Spots

From venue setup and sales method to local reviews. Spots actually talked about in Japanese-language media (Nikkei, Toyo Keizai, Hanako), Tabelog, and Instagram.



Big-corporate type

SUMADORI Meets

Tokyo, Omotesando Jingumae · Relocated and opened Apr 2026 (Asahi Breweries x Dentsu)

Setup — selling the "freedom to choose" your ABV

A concept where guests choose **0% / 0.5% / 3%** ("smart drinking"). From 100+ options in its Shibuya days, the new Omotesando location expanded with **180 original cocktails + a drinking-style diagnosis** content. A student-conceived initiative squarely targeting younger audiences.

Assessment — 46,000 cumulative visitors in its Shibuya days (600-800 yen range). Nikkei and Toyo Keizai spotlight the "13.3 million untapped market." In July 2025 it tested Korea too with its first overseas pop-up in Seoul's Seongsu.



Artisan cocktail-bar type

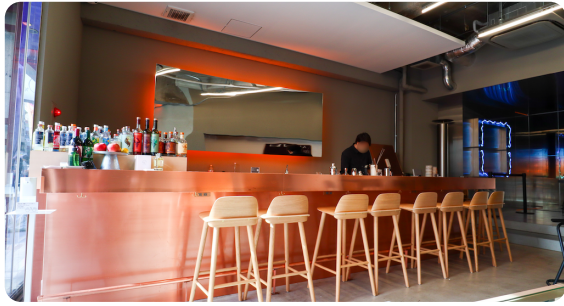
LOW-NON-BAR

Tokyo, Nihonbashi · Japan's first low/non-alcoholic cocktail bar (2020, Orchard Knight)

Setup — the "experience" of a proper bar, intact

The authentic bar mood of dark wood and suited bartenders. The front of the menu is low-alcohol; **flip it over and it's non-alcoholic**. Classified not by ABV but by **light/medium/heavy (how you enjoy it)**. Serious mocktails built on Seedlip, NEMA, and house-made purées.

Assessment — a Tabelog, Hanako, and RETRIP regular feature, and a buzz topic on Instagram. Praised for "breaking the assumption that drinks = booze" and "enjoying without a hangover." Drinkers and non-drinkers stand on equal footing.



Experiential / vegan type

0% NON-ALCOHOL EXPERIENCE

Tokyo, Roppongi · Japan's first 100% vegan + non-alcoholic bar

Setup — differentiating through "spatial experience"

A "the first bar born in outer space" concept, an art-plus-sound fusion space.

20+ mocktails (e.g., A Real Pleasure 1,500 yen, kombucha sparkling 900 yen), plus vegan food and CBD brownies. Per-customer spend of 2,000–3,000 yen.

Assessment — praised for "relaxing comfortably even though it isn't alcohol" and "aroma and taste close to the real thing." Its stylish visuals are an SNS check-in point.

Spreading — Kyoto has a "bar handling only non-alcoholic" (castle concept, 100+ options), and Osaka Honmachi's **TMBM** lowered the bar's threshold with a takeout mocktail stand. Tokyo Station's **Bar & Cafe Camellia** seals mocktails on the spot as a performance, and the Imperial Hotel bar offers non-alcoholic cocktails in a traditional setting — non-alcoholic has become not a "substitute" but **a genre of its own**.

How to "Sell" Non-Alcoholic — 3 Things

- ① **Sell ABV as a "choice."** Let the guest pick 0% / 0.5% / 3% — so drinkers and non-drinkers share the same menu at the same table.
- ② **Build the menu as an "experience."** Create a reason to have fun "even without drinking" through light/medium/heavy classifications, drinking-style diagnoses, and performances like on-the-spot sealing.
- ③ **Widen the audience to "together."** When non-drinking companions (drivers, expectant mothers, the health-conscious) can join, the group headcount itself grows — non-alcoholic doesn't save "one person," it saves "the table."

FEATURE 04 · NON-ALCOHOLIC PRODUCTS SELLING WELL IN KOREA

From Beer to Wine — Best Picks by Category

Alcohol-free (0.00%) and low/non-alcoholic (under 1%) are different. For guests who are driving or working, guide them to 0.00%; for atmosphere and flavor, guide them to low/non-alcoholic.

Category	Representative products	One-line feature
Beer (alcohol-free / low-alc)	Hite Zero 0.00 · Cass 0.0 / All Zero · Kloud Non-Alcoholic · Heineken 0.0 · Tsingtao Non-Alcoholic · Budweiser Zero	Hite Zero is the No.1 share (37.5%, alcohol-free 0.00%). Cass All Zero is "4-Free" (alcohol, sugar, calories, gluten). Among imports, Heineken 0.0 is the standout.
Wine	Leitz Eins-Zwei-Zero Riesling · Thomson & Scott Noughty Sparkling Chardonnay	Flavor preserved via post-fermentation vacuum distillation. Noughty is organic/vegan/halal certified and critically acclaimed — gift and dining demand.
Sparkling	Pol Giro Sparkling · Vendôme Rosé · Gustavshof Holunder Sekt	Champagne-style staging for anniversaries and parties. Vendôme Rosé is organic and Gustavshof is a vegan rosé — a substitute "celebration drink."
Spirits & mocktail bases	Seedlip · Lyre's · NEMA	Non-alcoholic gin and aperitifs. Mixed with tonic or soda, they're the base for non-alcoholic highballs and mocktails — great for building a house signature.

※ Product lineups vary by timing and distributor. Alcohol-free = 0.00% alcohol; low/non-alcoholic = under 1% (under Korea's Liquor Tax Act, "not classified as liquor" means under 1%).

To Our Owners — Here's How to Do Non-Alcoholic in Your Venue

①

1-2 bottled non-alcoholic beers, always in stock

Keep 1-2 SKUs fixed among Cass 0.0, Heineken 0.0, and Hite Zero. Capture drivers, expectant mothers, the health-conscious, and daytime drinkers — down to the "+1 companion."

②

1 non-alcoholic wine or sparkling

For gift, anniversary, and pairing demand. Even just one — Naughty Sparkling, Pol Giro, etc. — can substitute for a "celebration drink," reinforcing per-customer spend and gifting demand.

③

A non-alcoholic highball / mocktail signature

Make one house signature with Seedlip and non-alcoholic tonic. List the Japanese-style "ABV choice" (0% / low-alc) on the menu card.

④

Make it "visible" with a menu card

Non-alcoholic doesn't sell if it isn't seen. Show it with a separate menu card and POP — so drivers and health-conscious guests seek it out first.

SEWANG supply — the Cass 0.0, Heineken 0.0, and Hite Zero bottle line, plus curated non-alcoholic wine and sparkling, all in one go. We'll also help design your venue's non-alcoholic menu.

PART 03 • CHANNEL STRATEGY & JULY OUTLOOK

Three Channels — Here's How We Take July

Based on the June closing, here are the July actions for the hotel, izakaya, and pub channels.

🏨 CHANNEL 01 • Hotel & Fine Dining — Premium Curation

Absorb the healthy-pleasure segment with story whiskies (single malts) + natural wine + **non-alcoholic spritz / mocktail** pairings. A channel where per-customer spend is the weapon.

酒 CHANNEL 02 · Izakaya & Japanese — Signature Highball + Chilled Sake

Classic highball + flavored + **1 house signature highball** · For sake, reposition for summer by switching from warm sake to chilled (hiyazake) and offering a sake-highball kit. With **1 non-alcoholic highball / mocktail** (see the special), absorb even the non-drinking companion.

麥 CHANNEL 03 · Pubs, Pocha & Hof — Seasonal Lager + Non-Alcoholic

Pre-order summer lagers +20-30% + **display 1 non-alcoholic bottle alongside** to reinforce both turnover and per-customer spend. For chicken venues, run a "chimaek" pairing POP.

SEWANG's promise — "Keep the basics (draft) thick · Move fast on variations (signature highballs) · Never miss non-alcoholic · Reposition sake · Serve bottle-shop partners with curation." SEWANG is with you across products, kits, consulting, and promotion.

PART 04 · ABOUT SEWANG

Your Full-Range Liquor Wholesale Partner for Seoul & Gyeonggi

SEWANG Co., Ltd.

Full-range liquor distribution for hotels, restaurants, and pubs across Seoul & Gyeonggi · Founded 1985 · This report is for external trade-partner distribution

DISTRIBUTION CHANNELS

Hotels · Fine dining · Korean pubs · Izakaya · Pocha · Clubs · Lounge bars · Bottle shops

CATEGORIES HANDLED

Beer (Hitejinro, OB, Lotte) · Non-alcoholic · Imported beer · Whisky · Wine · Sake · Makgeolli · Soju · Traditional liquor (※ canned RTD not handled)

SERVICES

Weekly market insight reports · New-venue scouting · SNS intelligence for partners · New-product promotion & launch support · Pairing consulting

MAIN CONTACT

02-2203-5311

60 Jinhwangdo-ro 61-gil, Gangdong-gu, Seoul · 100 m on foot from Bohun Hospital Stn. (Line 9), Exit 1
www.sewang.co.kr · msjung75@gmail.com · CEO Jung Min-sung

Title	Name	Direct (010)	Territory / Notes
Vice President	Lee Han-woo	010-5210-5449	Head of Sales — Hotel & fine-dining channel
Senior Managing Director	Lim Chang-soo	010-3742-3054	Seoul Gangnam area (Gangnam, Yeoksam, Nonhyeon, Sinsa)
Senior Managing Director	Park Jeong-eon	010-3286-9489	Head of Sales · In charge of publishing this report
Director	Lee Won-chul	010-3354-2101	Seoul Gangbuk, Jongno, Jung-gu
Director	Kim Hwan	010-4789-3282	Seoul Mapo, Seodaemun, Yeonnam, Hongdae
Director	Shin Hong-chul	010-9259-6474	Gyeonggi Gwanggyo, Suwon, Bundang, Pangyo
General Manager	Bae Jong-hwan	010-9209-6526	Seoul Gangseo, Magok, Balsan, Yeouido
General Manager	Yoo Kwang-seok	010-4565-6039	Gyeonggi Hanam, Misa, Guri, Namyangju
General Manager	Seong Hyun-woo	010-3375-3646	Seoul Yeongdeungpo, Guro, Yangcheon, Dongjak
Deputy General Manager	Hwang Hyun-woong	010-9123-4341	Seoul & Gyeonggi new-partner scouting (SNS / local)
SPECIALIST LEADS — CATEGORY DEDICATED			
Director	Chae Hyun-yong	010-8889-3057	Specialist — Premium (wine & whisky) · bottle-shop curation
Director	Oh Geon-hoon	010-3495-6515	Specialist — Japanese liquor (sake)
Executive Managing Director	Son Seung-il	010-7539-3535	Specialist — Franchise

※ Territory assignments are subject to change. We recommend first contacting the main line (02-2203-5311) for guidance.

DATA SOURCES

- Sometrend SNS — measured monthly Instagram mention volume for draft beer, highball, non-alcoholic, and sake, plus "hotspot/bar" associated terms (Dec 2025 – Jun 2026)

- H1 popular venues — Naver blogs, local search (cross-verified across Naver and Kakao Map), Instagram mentions (first half of 2026)
- Japanese non-alcoholic specialty venues — Nikkei, Toyo Keizai, Business Insider Japan, Hanako, Time Out Tokyo, Tabelog, Asahi Breweries official (SUMADORI Meets, Apr 2026 Omotesando opening), 0% official, Metropolis
- Korea non-alcoholic market & products — Euromonitor (KRW 70.4B → 94.6B), Korea Economic Daily, Electronic Times, HiteJinro, Lotte Chilsung, OB Beer, Heineken Korea, Wine21, Masija Magazine
- SEWANG internal statistics and on-site partner checks (first half of 2026)

SEWANG Market Insight June Closing Report · Liquor distribution across Seoul & Gyeonggi since 1985 · This material is for market reference only and is not a solicitation to invest or start a business.

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